How classes work: in person and online

Some learners take part in a mix of in-person and online classes. This page explains the weekly pattern, what an online class looks like, what each learner needs, and how we keep every learner safe. The camp has no tests and no marks. Every class, in person or online, ends with something you built and saved.

The weekly pattern

Class	Where	How long
One core class a week, on Saturday	In person at The National ICT Innovation Hub, Nakawa	3 hours
The other core classes of the week	Online on video, with screen sharing	About 90 minutes live, then about an hour of your own build time
Foundation labs F01 to F04, in weeks 1 to 4	Online on a fourth day each week (the organiser sets the day)	2 hours live, as designed

The organiser confirms the exact days and times before the first class. Parents and guardians are told the class times in writing.

An in-person class (3 hours)

The same shape every time, with the instructor in the room.

Minutes	What happens
10	Recall: three questions on paper
50	Block A: predict, run, investigate, modify
15	Break away from screens
50	Block B: predict, run, investigate, modify
40	Make: your own task and your project journal
15	Exit sentence, save, and a check with each learner

An online class (about 90 minutes live, then your own build time)

The live part is on video with screen sharing. You do the guess, the run and the questions with the instructor. You finish the building in your own time.

Minutes	What happens live
5	Recall: three questions, answered aloud
35	Block A: predict, run, investigate
5	Break away from the screen
35	Block B: predict, run, investigate
10	Close: you say your exit sentence, then the build task is set

The Modify steps and the Make task move to the after-class build task. It takes about an hour. Each session's sheet and notebook already hold these steps, so you know what to do.

Returning your build task

Before the next class, send a photo of your work or your notebook. The route the organiser sets is the only route to use. A file saved on your laptop has not been shared until you send it that way. Use your nickname or learner code in file names. Add a line to your build log and tick the stamp on your progress map.

If you are stuck for 30 minutes, stop. Save the error message, take a photo and bring it to the next class.

Online labs

An online lab runs for the full 2 hours with the clock in its guide. There is no after-class task. Unfinished work carries into the next core class.

Before your first online class

Check each item at least a day before. Ask the instructor if anything fails.

1. A laptop, with its charger plugged in. A phone is not enough for the live part.
2. Internet that holds a video call. Test it at the place and time you will use.
3. Headphones, so you can hear clearly and your family can work nearby.
4. The camp notebook installed and tested. Open the first notebook (ML01), run one cell and save it. Run preflight_stack.py once.
5. A backup if the connection drops: the PDF sheet for the class and the notebook are already on your laptop. If the call drops, keep working from the sheet, rejoin when you can, and send your work as usual.
6. A notebook and pen, because every guess is written on paper first.

Staying safe online

Under-18s learn safely when everyone follows the same rules.

- A parent or guardian knows the class link and is told the class times.
- All messages stay in the agreed channel. No private messages outside it, in either direction.
- No recording without written consent from a parent or guardian. Nobody takes screenshots of other learners.
- Your camera is on for the live part, so the instructor can see your paper guesses and help you.
- Choose a calm space, ideally in a shared part of the home. You can leave the call at any time and tell your guardian.
- If something makes you uncomfortable, tell a parent or guardian and the organiser. Nobody gets into trouble for telling.

If an online class is not working for a learner, the instructor will invite them to the Saturday class and tell the parent kindly.